HEALTHCARE INTELLIGENCE · FROM PUBLIC SOURCES NO. 1

VIGILLINE DAILY

MONDAY, 26 OCTOBER 2026 BENGALURU COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Merck and Moderna report the first success for a personalised cancer vaccine

The readout filled the presidential symposium hall at the European Society for Medical Oncology congress in Madrid and was the most anticipated of the meeting; STAT called it the first effective cancer vaccine after 100 years.

Merck and Moderna presented Phase 3 data for their personalised cancer vaccine at the European Society for Medical Oncology congress in Madrid, in the presidential symposium — a hall that can seat thousands of people and which Endpoints News reported was full. Endpoints' weekly review of the congress had named the same study as the readout the meeting was waiting for, ahead of every other dataset on the programme.

Endpoints News headlined its report of the session 'a triumph of science', and added that the work now begins. The consequence is structural rather than incremental: a personalised cancer vaccine now has a Phase 3 readout behind it, the result the field had been waiting for, and the modality stops being an experiment and becomes a late-stage programme.

Attention turns next to breadth. STAT reported that the push is now on to get cancer vaccines working in more tumour types, which is where the commercial case will be settled. One indication supports a launch and several support a franchise, and that difference shows up in how quickly competing programmes are financed.

The material reviewed for this issue does not carry the effect size, the trial population or a filing timeline. VigilLine is not reporting figures it cannot attribute; those will come with the presentation and the manuscript, and the regulatory route for a personalised product will be watched as closely as the survival curves.

IN NUMBERS

58%

risk-of-death reduction, Imdelltra plus Imfinzi versus Imfinzi alone, first-line maintenance small cell lung cancer

44%

risk-of-death reduction for Roche's next-generation KRAS G12C inhibitor, head-to-head lung cancer trial

67,000

healthcare GCC job openings projected in India in 2026, Quess Corp

ALSO TODAY

Treasury proposal could curb China investment in biotech
ENDPOINTS NEWS

At ESMO, AstraZeneca's cancer pursuits get a showcase
STAT NEWS

US measles cases rise to 4,588 as outbreak continues
ET HEALTHWORLD

BRIEFS

Imdelltra with Imfinzi cuts risk of death by 58% in small cell lung cancer

Amgen's Imdelltra, given with AstraZeneca's Imfinzi, cut the risk of death by 58% versus Imfinzi alone in first-line maintenance for certain small cell lung cancer patients, in a Phase 3 trial reported at ESMO. The comparator was Imfinzi alone, not placebo.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Roche's KRAS G12C inhibitor beats same-target rivals by 44% on survival

Roche's next-generation KRAS G12C inhibitor cut the risk of death by 44% against drugs with the same target from Amgen and Bristol Myers Squibb, in previously treated mutant non-small cell lung cancer. The trial was a head-to-head against two marketed rivals in the same class.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Akeso sets out ivonescimab survival data in biliary tract cancer

Akeso detailed the size of the survival benefit from ivonescimab, its PD-1xVEGF bispecific partnered with Summit Therapeutics, in a late-stage biliary tract cancer study run in China only, and drew comparisons with Keytruda.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

AstraZeneca tests a Tagrisso-Orpathys pair after Tagrisso resistance

AstraZeneca said on Sunday that a Tagrisso-Orpathys combination may allow patients with mutant non-small cell lung cancer to keep taking Tagrisso after they become resistant to the EGFR inhibitor. The claim is stated as a possible benefit, and trial details were not in the material reviewed.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

India's healthcare GCC sector projected to add 67,000 jobs in 2026

Quess Corp's India Healthcare GCC Outlook 2026 projects the sector will generate 67,000 job openings in 2026, with nearly 93 per cent of demand concentrated among professionals with 3–12 years of experience. Quess attributed the pattern to a growing preference for specialised, mid-career talent.

ET HEALTHWORLD

Three-member panel to review India's pharma marketing rules

The government has set up a three-member committee to assess whether existing safeguards against unethical pharmaceutical marketing are effective, and to recommend changes to improve monitoring and enforcement.

EXPRESS PHARMA

SOURCES

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